



Harish Chandra
Manager, Area Information
Systems, Le Meriden

Like any hospitality entity, Le Meriden uses Fidelio, a Property Management System. Like any conventional CRM module, we get anytime data on the number of guests arrived, their duration of stay, the food they eat. It all helps us judge their likes and dislikes, and convert them into loyal customers of Le Meriden. In addition, the module helps keep a list of contacts of people who bring orders for us, and companies that regularly use our rooms for seminars or business stay. So, we are in the know of things of who gives us more business. The module should be ideally implemented in two phases, but most hotels implement it at one go. The prices for such modules specific to the hospitality industry also varies. We were charged \$76 per room, and a training stint of 20 days cost us \$350 a day. We have been using the module since 2000. For us, it's like a magician that helps retain customers and build lasting relationships.

DELIGHT



Rajesh Dixit
Senior CRM Specialist
SAS India

With ever-changing customer expectations and increasing competition in markets that are already saturated, survival is getting more and more difficult. Part of the problem is that most organisations still don't have a comprehensive view of their customers. They still don't understand who their customers are, which ones are the most prospective or profitable, what their preferences and attitudes are, and what they respond to. CRM bridges this information gap by leveraging the organisation's existing investments in technology, as well as all of data from multiple sources to give a complete view of all the customers across channels. CRM enables organisations to collect, analyse and interpret customer information, have confidence in the results, and communicate the results across the enterprise. It helps organisations build more profitable customer relationships, and retain their existing customers, thereby, providing them with measurable return on investment.



Pritesh Thakker
Manager
UTI Bank

At UTI Bank, we always felt the need to provide a uniform and standard response towards customers. We did keep in mind the necessity to cater to customer queries on banking products, with standard answers, and conformed to our intention of customer satisfaction. We also considered customer feedback, since it forms the basis of value-added services. Hence, the UTI committee decided to implement the standard Oracle CRM Suite to manage our requirements. We just finished implementing the query phase last July. This tool will be used by our 150-seater call centre to handle customer queries. All our call centre executives have been trained to maintain the standards that UTI subscribes to. With this system in place, we expect to relieve our branches of day-to-day queries. This would help the staff speed up work. CRM without analysis is like food without salt. Apart from being used to service customers via phone-banking, the CRM tool assists in analysing customer behaviour. It enables the bank to gauge the effectiveness of services, product penetration, and marketing information.

As told to Aparna Krishnakumar